A note for parents and carers

The importance of knowing about nature

In this technological age, being aware of the beauty and complexity of nature is an important part of our wellbeing. If you take the time to look and listen to what is around you, you'll discover all sorts of natural wonders. Even on a city street, the world is teaming with plant and animal life, and in every habitat on Earth, each living organism is important in its own way.

Young children are natural explorers. They like to touch and smell and immerse themselves in their environment. This book will give them the vocabulary to talk about what they have experienced, and build their knowledge of topics relating to wildlife, the environment, and our planet. It will prompt children to ask questions and lead them to look further and to learn more.

I grew up with "elephant" and "giraffe" as familiar words in my alphabet books, but my grandchildren may never see those animals in real life. We have reached an important moment in the future of our planet. The choices we make now will affect the lives of our children and our children's children, so it is important that we are all fully informed of our impact on the planet and what we can do to protect it. This book is a great place to start a young child's appreciation for the natural world and to begin to talk about living responsibly on our planet.

Jules Pottle
Primary science consultant, teacher, trainer, and author